[HIST-EVT-005] Publication of the First Tangkhul Primer

Translation / Context: Inauguration of Tangkhul Print Literature

Category: HISTORICAL_EVENT | Period: Colonial Period (Early 20th Century) | Date: 1902
Place: Shillong / Ukhrul [Ukhrul] | Dialect: Ukhrul
Source: Assam Secretariat Press, Shillong (1902)
Clearance: Public Domain | Permission: public_domain | Status: verified

---

Key Figures: Rev. William Pettigrew, Hunphun Village Informants, Assam Secretariat Press

Topography: Shillong (Printing) & Ukhrul (Educational Distribution)

Overview: First printed reading textbook adapting the Roman alphabet to Tangkhul phonology, inaugurating formal vernacular education across the Manipur eastern hills.

Indigenous Tangkhul Chronicle / Oral Memory:

1902 kumli Assam Secretariat Press, Shillong-li Rev. Pettigrew-wui Tangk
Roman akshar-li Tangkhul phonology mathat-da lakahon, tui-ming kashun ka
Hina Tangkhul rali lairik kakharang-wui rawung-tui kakhon shurung-da tho

---

English Translation & Scholarly Interpretation:

In 1902, the First Tangkhul Primer was printed at the Assam Secretariat
It adapted the Roman alphabet with diacritical macrons to represent Tang
The primer transformed an exclusively oral culture into a literate socie

---

Chronological Milestones & Key Events:

1. 1897-1901: Fieldwork by Pettigrew analyzing Ukhrul phonemes with native informants Raihao and local pupils.
2. 1902: Primer published under official sanction of the Chief Commissioner of Assam.
3. 1903: Adoption of the primer in all hill mission and village day-schools across Ukhrul district.
4. 1904: Publication of companion arithmetic and reading manuals based on the primer’s phonetic standard.

Key Tangkhul Historical Terminology:

* Akshar : Letter / alphabetic character
* Tui-ming : Spoken word / lexical term
* Lairik pakhang : Reading books / literacy study